

DecisionBrief — Conversation Transcript

Scenario: outsourcing • Customer Support • 28-Person SaaS • \$18k/mo Cost • Outsource vs In-House

2026-05-14 04:10 PM

DecisionBrief: Deciding whether to outsource? Tell me about the function you're evaluating and why now?

You: I run a 28-person SaaS company in Austin — \$4.2M ARR, B2B property management software. We have 4 full-time support reps handling about 600 tickets a month plus 80 chats a day, covering 8am-6pm CST only. No 24/7. Team cost is about \$18k/month with benefits — \$14k salary plus \$4k tools and manager time. Ticket backlog grew to 48 hours after we launched new leasing module, CSAT dropped to 3.8 from 4.6, and 2 reps quit last month. CEO wants 24/7 and under \$12k/month.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — 28-person SaaS \$4.2M ARR, 4 support reps \$18k/mo \$14k salary + \$4k tools, 600 tickets/mo 80 chats/day 8am-6pm only, backlog 48hrs after leasing module launch, CSAT 3.8 from 4.6, 2 reps quit, CEO wants 24/7 under \$12k/mo. What's the current approach and what broke?

You: Current is in-house 4 reps in Austin office, using Zendesk \$500/month plus Intercom \$400/month, manager spends 15 hours a week QA and escalations. We tried hiring 2 more at \$45k salary each but market is tough — took 3 months last time and they quit after 2 months because night shifts. We also tried part-time VA from Philippines \$800/month but quality was low — wrong answers on lease accounting. Now support is bottleneck for retention — churn went from 2% to 3.5% monthly.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — in-house Austin Zendesk \$500 + Intercom \$400, manager 15hrs QA, hiring 2 more \$45k each took 3 months and quit after 2 months, VA \$800/mo Philippines quality low on lease accounting, churn 2% to 3.5%. support bottleneck. What have you considered so far?

You: Looked at SupportNinja, Influx, and Televerde. SupportNinja quoted \$9k/month for 24/7 team of 6 with property management experience. Influx quoted \$7.5k/month but no dedicated team — shared. Televerde quoted \$12k/month with US team but no 24/7. Also considered keeping in-house and hiring 2 more at \$45k each = \$90k/year extra plus \$4k tools = total \$25k/month, which is over budget. Friend said outsource Tier 1 only and keep Tier 2 in-house.

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DecisionBrief: Clear — SupportNinja \$9k/mo 24/7 team 6 with property mgmt exp, Influx \$7.5k shared, Televerde \$12k US no 24/7, in-house hire 2 more \$90k extra + \$4k tools = \$25k/mo over budget, friend idea outsource Tier 1 keep Tier 2 in-house. What's your budget and constraints?

You: Budget \$12k hard cap \$15k if perfect monthly all-in including Zendesk and Intercom, vs \$18k now. Need monthly contract not annual — can't lock 12 months if quality fails. Need live by August 1 before fall leasing season — 6 weeks. Need to keep CSAT above 4.4 and first response under 2 hours vs 48 hours now. Need to keep escalation path to product team — can't have outsourced team guessing on accounting.

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DecisionBrief: Got it — \$12k cap \$15k perfect monthly all-in vs \$18k now, monthly not annual, live by Aug 1 6 weeks, CSAT above 4.4 first response under 2hrs vs 48hrs now, escalation to product for accounting. What must it actually do beyond 24/7?

You: Must handle Tier 1 tickets — password resets, how to run reports, lease renewal workflow, 600 tickets/mo and 80 chats/day, with macros that are accurate on lease accounting — VA gave wrong answers before. Must be 24/7 including weekends — we have no coverage now 6pm-8am and weekends. Must integrate with Zendesk and

Slack for escalation, manager still wants 5 hours QA not 15 hours. Must keep 2 in-house senior reps for Tier 2 accounting questions. And must have QA reports and CSAT tracking, not black box. Data security — SOC2 because we store rent data.

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DecisionBrief: Understood — Tier 1 600 tickets 80 chats/day accurate lease accounting macros, 24/7 including weekends no coverage 6pm-8am now, Zendesk + Slack escalation, manager 5hrs QA not 15hrs, keep 2 senior in-house Tier 2, QA reports CSAT tracking not black box, SOC2 for rent data. What worries you most about outsourcing?

You: Quality drop like VA \$800/mo gave wrong lease accounting answers and CSAT 3.8 to worse, control loss — outsourced team doesn't know product and churn stays 3.5%, data security — rent data and SSN in tickets SOC2 needed, hidden costs — \$9k quoted then \$3k extra for QA and manager, and losing 2 in-house reps who quit last month means knowledge loss if outsource fails and we have no fallback. Also client asks for US support and Philippines might hurt brand.

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DecisionBrief: Thanks — quality drop wrong lease accounting and CSAT worse, control loss churn 3.5% stays, SOC2 rent data SSN security, \$9k then \$3k extra QA hidden cost, knowledge loss 2 reps quit no fallback, US vs Philippines brand are kev. What does success look like in 6 months?

You: In 6 months first response under 2 hours not 48 hours, CSAT back to 4.6 from 3.8, churn back from 3.5% to 2% monthly, 24/7 coverage live including weekends, cost under \$12k/month vs \$18k now all-in with Zendesk \$500 + Intercom \$400, manager QA down from 15 hours to 5 hours, 2 senior in-house reps handling Tier 2 accounting questions, outsourced Tier 1 handling 600 tickets and 80 chats with accurate lease accounting macros, QA reports showing accuracy, no security incident, and we handled fall leasing season without backlog.

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DecisionBrief: I have enough information to prepare your Decision Brief.